AOU
الجامعة العربية المفتوحة
Arab Open University

Arab Open University
FACULTY OF LANGUAGE STUDIES

A112T
Cultures
Main - All Branches
Final Exam

2025-2026/Summer Semester
Date: 1 September 2026
9:30 – 12:30

Number of Exam Pages: 3 (including this cover sheet)	Time Allowed: 3 Hours

INSTRUCTIONS

This exam consists of TWO PARTS.

PART 1 contains 3 SHORT ANSWER QUESTIONS. You must choose TWO and answer them in PARAGRAPH FORMAT.

PART 2 contains 3 ESSAY QUESTIONS. You must choose TWO and answer them in ESSAY FORMAT.

Write the question number next to each answer.

Do not answer more questions than required.

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Part 1: Short Answer Questions

(10 points = 5 points for each answer)

Please choose TWO of the following questions and respond to them in paragraph format. Each answer should be approximately 80 words long, addressing all relevant aspects of the question with appropriate evidence from the course material. Ensure that each paragraph includes a clear topic sentence, supporting details, and a conclusion.

1. What is the **Naxian Sphinx**, where was it located, and what was its purpose in the sanctuary of Delphi?
2. What is the **literary canon**, and how do literary works come to be included or excluded from it?
3. What is **ekphrasis**, and how does it appear in *Twelfth Night*?

Part 2: Essay Questions

(40 points= 20 points for each essay)

Please choose TWO of the essay prompts below and write comprehensive responses in essay format. Your essays should be around 350 words each, covering all relevant aspects of the questions and backed by evidence from the course material. Make sure to structure your essays with an introduction, multiple body paragraphs, and a conclusion.

4. How did the **events at Delphi** show **what it meant to be Greek**? Discuss how **Greek identity (Greekness)** was expressed through the **Pythian Games**, **religious dedications**, and **consulting the Oracle**.

Sub-Questions (20 marks total — 4 marks each)

a. What did Greek identity or Greekness mean in the context of Delphi? (4 Marks)
b. Describe the Pythian Games and their role in Greek religious life. (4 Marks)
c. Explain the purpose of religious dedications and votive offerings at Delphi. (4 Marks)
d. Give one example of an Oracle consultation, sacred event, or dedication at Delphi. (4 Marks)
e. Why was Delphi important for expressing Greek identity and unity? (4 Marks)

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5. Discuss how ***Twelfth Night*** **challenges traditional gender roles** and **explores identity** through **disguise** and **cross-dressing**.

Sub-Questions (20 marks total — 4 marks each)

a. What were traditional gender roles in Elizabethan England? (4 Marks)
b. Define cross-dressing in Shakespearean comedy. How does Viola's disguise as Cesario drive the plot? (4 Marks)
c. How does Viola's male disguise allow her to express desires and traits forbidden to Elizabethan women? (4 Marks)
d. Using specific scenes, explain how the love triangle between Viola/Cesario, Olivia, and Orsino challenges fixed ideas of gender and attraction. (4 Marks)
e. Does *Twelfth Night* mostly support or challenge traditional gender roles? Use evidence from the play to explain your answer. (4 Marks)

6. Discuss **Malvolio** and the **festive conflict** in ***Twelfth Night*** and explain how **the gulling scene** reflects **the clash between Puritanism and festivity**.

Sub-Questions (20 marks total — 4 marks each)

a. Who is Malvolio, and what role does he play in the comedy? (4 Marks)
b. Describe the festive characters who oppose him, such as Sir Toby, Andrew, Maria, and Feste. (4 Marks)
c. Explain the conflict between Puritanism and festivity in the play. (4 Marks)
d. Give one example of Malvolio's gulling or humiliation. (4 Marks)
e. Why is this conflict important for the play's humor and social criticism? (4 Marks)

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End of the Exam!

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